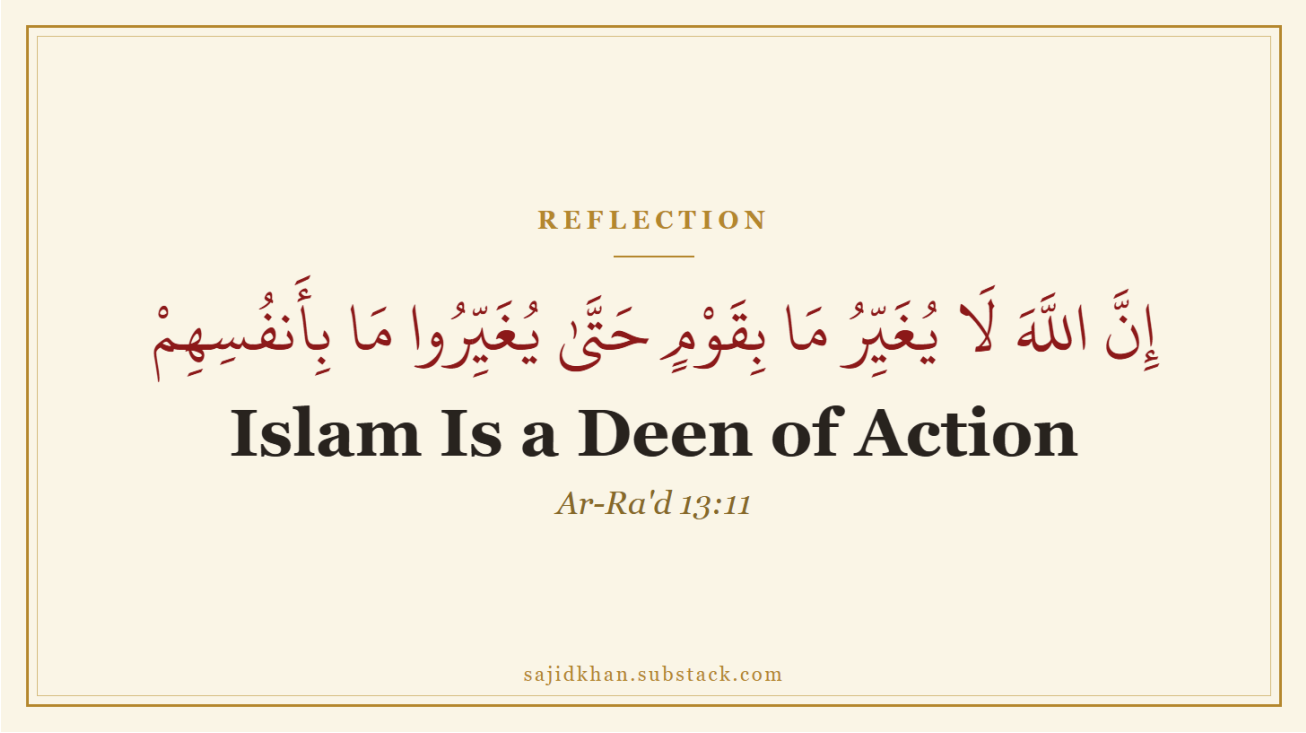


REFLECTION

Islam Is a Deen of Action

Not just du'a: 13:11 and 6:135

One of the best-known ayahs on change is in Surah Ar-Ra'd (13:11):

إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُغَيِّرُ مَا بِقَوْمٍ حَتَّىٰ يُغَيِّرُوا مَا بِأَنفُسِهِمْ

"Allah does not change the condition of a people until they change what is within themselves."

Allama Muhammad Iqbal built a whole view of life on this ayah. In his lectures *The Reconstruction of Religious Thought in Islam* he says that man is meant to shape his own destiny and the world around him, sometimes by adjusting to its forces and sometimes by bending them to good ends, and that in this work Allah becomes his co-worker, "provided man takes the initiative".

If we do not take that first step, Iqbal says, the spirit within us hardens and we sink to the level of dead matter. What connects us to the world, and lets us change it, is knowledge.

Work, and leave the result to Allah

In Surah Al-An'am (6:135):

قُلْ يَا قَوْمِ اعْمَلُوا عَلَىٰ مَكَانَتِكُمْ إِنِّي عَامِلٌ ۖ فَسَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ مَن تَكُونُ لَهُ عَاقِبَةُ الدَّارِ ۗ إِنَّهُ لَا يُفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ ﴿١٣٥﴾

"Say: My people, do all you can in your way; I too am working. You will soon know who will have the good end. The wrongdoers will never succeed."

Notice the words: اعْمَلُوا "work" and إِنِّي عَامِلٌ "I am working". The Prophet ﷺ is not told to sit and wait for the result. He is told to work. Du'a is the companion of action, not its replacement.

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